FREE CHECKLIST · VA 101 EP 37

VA Job Scam Checklist (2026)

Most clients are real. These checks protect you from the ones who are not.

Red flag	Why it is a scam
You did not apply, but got a text or Telegram job offer	Real employers do not cold-text random numbers
Huge pay for easy "tasks" like likes or reviews	Task scams pay a little first, then ask for deposits
You must deposit or "recharge" to unlock tasks	You will not get the bigger amount back
They send a check to buy equipment from "their vendor"	Fake check scam: the check bounces, your money is gone
They ask for your login, OTP or bank details	Account takeover
They push you off Upwork or OLJ right away	You lose platform payment protection
Training fee, starter kit or registration fee	Real jobs pay you, you do not pay them

Verify a client before you start

☐ Company website and email match the company name
☐ LinkedIn or Facebook page with real history
☐ On Upwork: payment verified, past hires, reviews
☐ A short video call with the person you will work for
☐ Start with a small paid task or milestone

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Never do and what to do

If something feels off, stop and verify first.

Never

- ☐ Pay to get a job or to get paid
- ☐ Send money back from a check or transfer you received
- ☐ Share OTPs, passwords or bank logins
- ☐ Buy equipment from the client's "vendor"
- ☐ Install remote access apps for a stranger

If you think you are being scammed

- ☐ Stop replying and do not send more money
- ☐ Take screenshots of chats, numbers and payment receipts
- ☐ Report the account on the platform (Upwork, OLJ, Facebook, Telegram)
- ☐ Report to the CICC anti-scam hotline 1326
- ☐ For task or "investment" job offers, report to the SEC (epd@sec.gov.ph)
- ☐ Tell your bank or e-wallet right away if you sent money

SAFE REPLY TO A SUSPICIOUS OFFER

Thanks for reaching out. I only work through the platform where the job was posted, and I never pay fees to start. If that works for you, please send the contract there.

Sources: Philippine SEC advisory on tasking job scams, CICC 1326 anti-scam hotline. Check the official sites for the latest advisories.